

The Free Channel: The Map Pack

Top Tier Roofing and Remodeling, LLC · how the top-3 local box works, and where you stand in it today

FREE, NO AD SPEND

When someone searches "roofer near me" or "roofing contractor Albertville MN," the first thing they usually see is not a list of blue links. It is a box with a small map and three business names, called the **local pack** or **map pack**. It sits above almost everything else on the page, it costs nothing to appear in, and it is where a homeowner with a leaking roof is most likely to stop looking and start calling.

28.8%

OF CLICKS GO TO THE MAP PACK

13.8%

OF CLICKS GO TO PAID LOCAL SERVICES ADS

\$0

COST TO APPEAR IN THE MAP PACK

Source: [BrightLocal, "Local Services Ads Click Study,"](#) published 2018, a controlled click study across five home-service trades. It is an industry benchmark, not a measurement of your own site, and roofing was not one of the trades tested. The pattern it shows, that the free map pack out-clicks paid Local Services ads, is the reason this channel is worth the same attention as anything you'd pay for.

1 How a position in the box gets won

Google itself names three things that decide who shows up in the map pack and in what order. None of them can be bought directly.

Distance

How far your business is from the person searching, or from the area they typed in.

"How far each business is from the customer who's searching."

Relevance

How well your listing matches what was searched: your categories, the services you list, and the words on your site and profile.

"How well a Business Profile matches what someone is searching for."

Prominence

How well-known and well-reviewed your business is: review count, review rating, and how complete your Google Business Profile is.

"More reviews and positive ratings can help your business's local ranking."

Source: Google's own local-ranking guidance, support.google.com/business/answer/7091.

Where you already stand on prominence: a 5.0 rating across 21 Google reviews, climbing, and every review answered so far. That is a genuinely strong prominence signal, and it is the hardest one for a competitor to fake. Several competitors in this trade area carry 300 to 700+ reviews, so the honest read is: quality is not the gap, volume is, and volume is a habit, not a redesign.

Where the picture is thin or simply unconfirmed: categories, service-area setup, photo count, hours as configured, and whether Posts or Q&A are being used are all things we cannot see from outside your Google Business Profile dashboard. That is not a finding that they are missing, it is a two-minute check that has not been made yet, and it is listed below because it is free and it is the fastest lever on relevance.

2 What moves this, this week, at no cost

- ☐ **Fill in every category your Google Business Profile dashboard offers.** A primary category of "Roofing contractor" plus every secondary category that genuinely applies (siding, gutters, remodeling) widens which searches you show up for.
- ☐ **Turn on service area for your towns.** Confirm Albertville, St Michael, Otsego, Monticello, Buffalo, and Elk River are set as service areas inside the profile, not just implied by your address.
- ☐ **Post an update when a job wraps.** Google Posts are a free feed attached to your listing. A finished job with a photo is a live, current signal that the business is active.
- ☐ **Add photos from finished jobs as they happen.** Photo count and recency both feed how complete and current your profile looks.
- ☐ **Keep replying to every new review.** You are already doing this on all 21. Do not let it slip as volume grows, it is one of the cheapest trust signals a homeowner reads before they call.

☐ **Check hours are accurate inside the profile itself.** The website states one set of hours; whether the Google listing matches is a two-minute check worth making once.

3 Where you actually rank today: a free position scan

To show what "prominence and distance" mean in practice, we checked where Top Tier shows up in Google's map results for a roofing search near each of your six towns.

Method and confidence, stated plainly: this was run using Google's live map results for a "[roofing search] near [town]" query, observed on **2026-09-02**, at zero cost. It reflects the full ranked list Google Maps returns, which the top-3 pack on a Google search draws from, but it is a single snapshot per town, not a multi-point grid across each town (the more expensive, paid version of this check). Read a top-3 finish below as strong evidence of a map-pack position. Read "not in the list" as evidence the business is not showing up prominently for that search, not proof it appears nowhere at all.

TOWN	SEARCH USED	RESULT	NOTES
Albertville	Roofing contractor near Albertville, MN	#2 of 14 IN THE PACK	Your home town. Well inside where the top-3 box draws from.
Otsego	Roofing contractor near Otsego, MN	#5 of 14 JUST OUTSIDE	Visible on the list, one tier below where the box cuts off.
St Michael	Six search variations tried	Not obtained	The free tool used could not return a result for this town on any of six tries. Genuinely unknown, not a finding of "not ranking." Worth a direct look in a browser.
Monticello	Roofer near Monticello, MN	Not in top 13	A 593-review incumbent (Perfect Exteriors) leads this town by a wide margin.
Buffalo	Roofing contractor near Buffalo, MN	Not in top 14	List is dominated by other Buffalo-based small shops.
Elk River	Roofing company near Elk River, MN	Not in top 14	A local incumbent (Northface Construction) leads this town.

The pattern matches what the prominence factor predicts: the town where you are strongest is the town you are physically in, and the towns where an established, heavily-reviewed competitor already sits are the towns where you do not yet show up. That is not a wall, it is the review-volume gap from Section 1 showing up as a ranking effect. Distance and relevance cannot fully make up for it in the towns you don't operate out of, but a growing review count and a fully filled-out profile close the gap that is actually closeable.